

Project A Questions and Discussion

- A. ***What is the main cause of air pollution?*** Air pollution can come from many sources, but major contributors include burning of fossil fuels, industrial emissions, and wildfires.
- B. ***Why does LA have unhealthy air quality?*** Los Angeles has unhealthy air quality mostly due to the burning of fossil fuels from vehicles, ships, planes, and manufacturing. L.A.'s large population leads to frequent traffic congestion and power consumption that heavily contributes to such emissions. LA also has the two busiest container ports in the U.S. and these ports rely on fossil fuels to power their ships and other transportation. LA's geography and proneness to wildfires are also a contributing factor to its unhealthy air quality.
- C. ***What health problems are caused by air pollution?*** Health problems such as heart diseases, respiratory illness/infections/inflammation, and premature death can be caused by air pollution.
- D. ***Has air quality improved in Los Angeles over the past 5 years?*** Los Angeles' air quality has improved over the past 5 years, even dramatically over the last 30 years. Lockdown due to the COVID-19 pandemic also helped in limiting the spread of emissions.
- E. ***What is the impact of COVID-19 to air quality?*** From March 7th-28th of 2020, L.A. experienced the longest stretch of WHO-target air quality ($< 10 \mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$) since at least 1995. This 18 day stretch of extremely clean air was due to the lockdown put in place to limit the spread of COVID in which essential businesses were forced to close and people were ordered to stay home.
- F. ***What is your neighborhood air quality?*** My neighborhood air quality is rated good with a US AQI of 20 and PM_{2.5} of $3.6 \mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$.
- G. ***How could we reduce air pollution in Los Angeles?*** We can reduce air pollution in L.A. by potentially reducing emission across the transportation sector along with other high-polluting industries. This could include making an effort to shift towards electric vehicles over motor vehicles, especially because of L.A.'s traffic conditions.
- H. ***What are the major air pollutants?*** The major air pollutants are particulate matter (PM) and ozone (nitrogen oxide and organic substances) pollution.

(n.d.) Los Angeles Air Quality. IQ Air. <https://www.iqair.com/us/usa/california/los-angeles>.

(n.d.) Air Pollution. World Health Organization.
https://www.who.int/health-topics/air-pollution#tab=tab_1.

